

Preventing and Responding to Violence, Abuse, Neglect, Exploitation and Discrimination Policy

VERSION	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER	APPROVED BY
1.0				

PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [redacted] actively prevents violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation and discrimination, how workers identify the signs early, and how allegations and incidents are responded to — with support for the affected participant, access to advocacy, records, and action to prevent recurrence.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [redacted] to apply the Violence, Abuse, Neglect, Exploitation and Discrimination NDIS Practice Standards. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [redacted] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[redacted] is committed to ensuring that:

- policies, procedures and practices are in place that actively prevent violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation or discrimination;
- each participant is given information about the use of an advocate (including an independent advocate), and access to an advocate is facilitated where allegations have been made; and
- allegations and incidents are acted upon, each affected participant is supported and assisted, records are made of details and of any reviews or investigations, and action is taken to prevent recurrence.

3. Zero tolerance

[redacted] prohibits violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation and discrimination in all forms by any person. People with disability have the same human rights as everyone else, including the right to respect for their human worth and dignity and to live free from violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation and discrimination.

[redacted] has systems to prevent the occurrence or recurrence of these harms within the service-delivery context.

4. Identifying it early

Workers are trained in the early identification of violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation and discrimination, taking particular care in known risk situations, both systemic and individual. The Schedule to this policy lists common physical indicators and behavioural signs for each type of abuse and for neglect — no single sign is

conclusive, but awareness improves the ability to recognise and respond. Regular system reviews identify and remedy gaps that could contribute to a person experiencing harm.

5. Responding effectively

Workers report and openly disclose any suspected or alleged incident under the Incident Management and Reporting Policy, and [REDACTED] protects any person who makes such a disclosure. Alleged incidents involving participants that are Reportable Incidents are reported to the NDIS Commission within the required timeframes.

A participant who experiences violence, abuse, neglect, exploitation or discrimination has the right to make a complaint without fear of retribution, to pursue grievances with [REDACTED], the NDIS Commission and the criminal justice system without their services being discontinued, and to access appropriate support services. Participants and their support network are given information about using an advocate, and access to an advocate is facilitated where allegations are made. Families and carers who identify and report incidents are supported.

6. Workforce and culture

Human resource management practices (recruitment and selection, criminal history screening, performance monitoring and development) support a safe workforce, and the workplace culture supports continuous learning to respond to the needs of the people being supported. Where State law requires it, workers comply with mandatory reporting obligations for children at risk of significant harm.

7. Definitions

[REDACTED]
[REDACTED], ABN [REDACTED].

Client

A client of [REDACTED], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[REDACTED], and other key management personnel involved in [REDACTED] from time to time.

Principal

[REDACTED].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [REDACTED].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [REDACTED].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [REDACTED], including the Principal.

Abuse

The violation of a person's human rights through an act or omission by another person — including physical, sexual, psychological/emotional, chemical, cultural and financial abuse.

Neglect

The failure to provide the necessary care, aid or guidance — including physical neglect, passive neglect, wilful deprivation, emotional neglect and crimes of omission.

Exploitation

Taking advantage of the vulnerability of a person with disability to use them, or their resources, for another's profit or advantage.

Discrimination

Treating an individual or group unfavourably because of a personal attribute protected by law — directly, or indirectly through an unreasonable requirement that disadvantages people with a protected attribute.

8. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Incident Report Form · Feedback and Complaints Policy · Promoting and Protecting Rights · Choice, Advocacy and Control Policy · Human Resources Management Policy · Client Money and Property Policy · Client Information Booklet · Legislation Register · Policy Register.

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
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